

Customer Integration Specialist Interview Case

Please prepare the following case for a 30-minute presentation during the interview. You would need to send the solution to the case 24 hours before the interview date. We are looking forward to your ideas.

Background Information

Our Professional Services teams are embedded in the Customer Experience department and follow the mission to help our customers unlock rapid, reliable, and repeatable value from our solutions, through product-enabled, scalable services delivered with a relentless focus on customer success.

The Integration services team enables our customers to embed Personio into their existing, and ever growing ecosystem of business technologies.

As a Customer Integration Specialist, you'll solve technically complex customer issues, consult with them on the right solutions to their use case, and lead team initiatives that continuously improve the customer experience.

Feel free to create a [Personio Trial Account](#) in order to present us your results for the following tasks. If you have questions you can visit our [Personio Voyager](#) or send us an email. Our developer hub is accessible at: <https://developer.personio.de/>

Programming Case

Imagine a 2,000 employee company wants to:

- Automatically export HR data and documents from Personio every day.
- Transform this data into CSV/Excel for payroll or reporting.
- Securely deliver files to their SFTP server, or make them available for their BI dashboards.

Design a lightweight solution that automatically extracts employee data from the Personio API and outputs a clean, well-structured CSV file for payroll or reporting.

- The customer runs the integration in their environment—whatever suits their IT setup.
- Our responsibility is to make the solution robust, easy to use, and secure—so even non-technical users can succeed.
- Customers can automate HR data exports and document transfers with minimal support.

- Data flows securely from Personio to their chosen systems, ready for payroll or analytics.
- Our toolkit is easy to configure, run, and troubleshoot—no hosting or complex IT required.

What Needs to Be Done

1. Design the ETL Process

- **Extract:**
Use Personio's public API to fetch relevant HR data and documents (employees, absences, recruiting records).
- **Transform:**
Process and clean the data—convert JSON to CSV/Excel, handle missing fields, standardize formats.
- **Load:**
Deliver the output to the customer's chosen destination: SFTP server, email, or save locally for manual upload to BI tools.

2. Build a Customer-Deployable Solution

- **Packaging:**
Develop the integration as a Python executable or Docker container, so customers can run it on their own systems (desktop, server, or cloud).
- **Configuration:**
Make it easy for customers to set up—provide a config file for API keys (should not be hardcoded), endpoints, schedules, and output formats.

3. Documentation & Enablement

- **Step-by-step guides:**
Show how to install, configure, and run the tool.
- **Troubleshooting:**
Document common errors and how to resolve them: API authentication issues, Incorrect permissions for reading/writing local files, Incorrect or missing configuration fields.
- **Security best practices:**
Educate on safe credential management and secure data transfer.

Further Information

Your solution should extract and include the following data sets:

- Employee Master Data
- Employment Details
- Current Compensation Information

Requirements

- Use the Personio API and decide on the endpoints ([V1/V2](#)) to be used.
- Transform the API response into **one CSV file** (schema below).
- The tool should be able to **run daily** and generate a fresh CSV output.
- For now simply produce the CSV file locally.
- Include **one simple post-processing step**, such as:
 - department-level summary (employee count, average base salary).
- Keep the solution simple and realistic, as if it were shared with a customer.

Standard Engineering Expectations

Your script or design should follow general best practices such as:

- **Clear, human-readable logging**
 - “Fetched 482 employees”, “CSV generated successfully”, “API token missing”
- **Error handling**
 - avoid crashes, return meaningful error messages
- **Configuration management**
 - API keys, output paths- should not be hard-coded
- **Clean structure**
 - easy for a customer or another engineer to follow
- **Reasonable naming conventions and comments**

Standard CSV Schema

Filename:personio_employee_export.csv

Columns:

- employeeID
- First name
- Last name
- email
- status
- Hire date
- Termination date
- position
- department
- team
- Supervisor name
- location
- Weekly working hours
- Employment type

- Cost center
- Base Salary
- Last modified

Formatting:

- Dates : YYYY-MM-DD
- Empty values : blank

Additional Output (Simple Department Summary)

File/print output with the following:

Columns:

- department
 - employee_count
 - average_base_salary
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